Meta Ads: Lookalike Audiences in Housing & Financial Services

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Short answer: No. Once a campaign is set to the **Housing** or **Financial Products & Services** special ad category (the same goes for Credit and Employment), Meta won't let you target a lookalike audience.

What changed and when

- Meta used to offer a substitute called **Special Ad Audiences**, which were lookalikes built without demographic signals. Meta removed them for all special ad categories in October 2022, after its settlement with HUD. There's no lookalike-style option left in these categories.
- **Financial Products & Services** became its own special ad category in early 2025. Loans, insurance, investing and similar offers now carry the same restrictions as Housing and Credit.

What else you can't use in these categories

- Detailed targeting exclusions
- Location exclusions
- Targeting by age, gender or ZIP code. Age is locked to 18–65+, and the location radius has a 15-mile minimum.
- Targeting expansion and bid multipliers

What you can still use

- **Custom audiences** (customer lists, website visitors, engagers) for retargeting, though Meta limits how they're used in these categories
- **Broad targeting** by location (with the radius minimum) and limited interest targeting, letting the creative and the pixel or CAPI conversion signal find the right people
- **Advantage+ audience**, where the category allows it
- Political ads are the one special category where regular lookalikes still work. That doesn't help for housing or finance.

One thing to avoid

Don't run the ads outside the special category just to keep lookalikes. Meta reviews ads in these categories and will flag them. That can get ads rejected or restrict the ad account.

Before you build

Confirm the current details in Meta's Business Help Center under "About Special Ad Categories." Meta changes the exact targeting options often, and this summary was compiled mostly from third-party sources rather than Meta's own documentation.

Sources

- Jon Loomer – Special Ad Categories: A Guide for Meta Ads
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- Elevarus – Final expense Meta ads special ad category targeting
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